

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥5

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦5

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦4

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 7♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦J

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣7

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 7 5

♥ Q J 6

♦ 8 2

♣ A J 6 4

♠ A 6 3

♥ K 10 7

♦ A 9 4

♣ Q 9 8 7



♠ 10 9 2

♥ 9 5 4 3 2

♦ 6 5

♣ 10 3 2

♠ K Q 4

♥ A 8

♦ K Q J 10 7 3

♣ K 5

SOUTH not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners. So when NORTH jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, SOUTH uses Gerber.

NORTH shows two Aces so SOUTH decides 6NT will be just right.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♥ 5			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 8 5

♥ J 6 3

♦ 8 7

♣ A Q J 4

♠ 4 2

♥ 5 2

♦ K 10 9 4 3 2

♣ 9 7 2



♠ A J 9 6 3

♥ A 4

♦ A Q J 6

♣ K 5

♠ 10 7

♥ K Q 10 9 8 7

♦ 5

♣ 10 8 6 3

When WEST gives immediate ♠ support, EAST's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so EAST bids 4NT.

WEST's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which EAST cleverly deduces must be the ♣A.

EAST bids 6♠ since WEST has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♠	Pass	5NT	Pass
6♣	Pass	6♠	

All Pass

6♠ by East

Lead: ♦ 5

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 7 2
 ♥ 3 2
 ♦ 10 6 4
 ♣ A 10 9 4 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A K 10

♦ K Q 2

♣ K Q 7 3



♠ 10 8 5 3

♥ 6 5

♦ A 7 5

♣ J 8 6 5

♠ A 6 4

♥ Q J 9 8 7 4

♦ J 9 8 3

♣ —

NORTH expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but SOUTH gives a positive 2♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

SOUTH then bids 3♠, showing first round control. NORTH tries 4NT (Blackwood) and SOUTH replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

NORTH bids 6♥, knowing they must lose the ♦A.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♦4			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 5
♥ A K 10 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6

♠ Q J 6

♥ 9 2

♦ J 5

♣ K 8 7 5 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 4 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 9 8 6 3

♣ —

♠ 10 9 7 3

♥ 4

♦ Q 10 4 2

♣ A Q 10 3

EAST's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

WEST bids 4NT, Blackwood.

EAST's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

WEST counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4NT	Pass	5NT	Pass
7♥			
All Pass			
7♥ by West			
Lead: ♦ J			

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 9 8 6 4

♥ 8 6

♦ 10 7

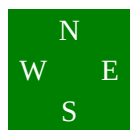
♣ A 8 5

♠ K 5 3

♥ K Q J 10 3

♦ A

♣ K Q 10 6



♠ Q 10 7 2

♥ 4 2

♦ Q J 5 3 2

♣ 7 4

♠ —

♥ A 9 7 5

♦ K 9 8 6 4

♣ J 9 3 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

6 ♥

All Pass

6 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣ 7

NORTH figures that if SOUTH holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

SOUTH only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

NORTH manages to figure out that SOUTH has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.